

MANAGING DIGITAL CONSUMPTION			
Category	Description	Tools/Apps	Tips/Strategies
Digital Usage Assessment	Track and analyse your digital device usage to understand your digital habits.	RescueTime, Screen Time, Digital Wellbeing	- Regularly review usage stats - Set limits for non-essential apps
Impact of Digital Overload	Understand the psychological, physical, and emotional effects of excessive digital consumption.	N/A	- Implement screen-free times - Reduce blue light exposure at night
Unhealthy Digital Habits	Identify compulsive checking, endless scrolling, and multitasking with devices.	StayFocusd, Freedom	- Establish specific times for digital activities - Use tech-free zones
Digital Decluttering	Manage and reduce digital clutter across emails, social media, and digital files.	Unroll.Me, Offtime, Flipd	- Unsubscribe from unnecessary emails - Organise digital files
Setting Detox Goals	Set personalised goals for reducing digital consumption and improving digital well-being.	Moment, QualityTime	- Define clear, measurable goals - Track progress and adjust as needed

Step-by-Step Guide to Identifying Your Unhealthy Habits

- **Keep a Digital Diary:** For one week, record your digital habits, including when and why you reach for your devices. Note how you feel before, during, and after using them.
- **Identify Triggers:** Look for patterns in your diary. What prompts you to pick up your phone or start browsing? Is it boredom, loneliness, anxiety, or habit?
- **Assess Your Feelings:** Pay attention to how different digital activities make you feel. Does scrolling through social media leave you feeling energised or drained?
- **Spot Unhealthy Habits:** Using your diary and emotional assessments, pinpoint which digital habits are unhealthy. These are habits that negatively impact your well-being or interfere with your real-life interactions and productivity.

Digital Decluttering Tools

To combat these unhealthy habits, consider using tools designed to help manage digital consumption:

- **StayFocusd or Freedom:** Use these apps to limit your time on specific websites or apps that you find particularly distracting or detrimental to your well-being.
- **Offtime or Flipd:** These apps help you create periods of minimal digital distraction by blocking access to most apps and notifications.

Setting Personalised Goals for Digital Detox

Balance doesn't mean eliminating digital devices from your life entirely but finding a way to use them that supports your well-being, productivity, and real-world relationships.

Steps to Setting Your Digital Detox Goals

- **Reflect on Your Desired Outcomes:** What do you hope to

achieve with a digital detox? More free time? Better sleep? Improved focus?

- **Create Specific, Measurable Goals:** Based on your desired outcomes, set specific and measurable goals. For example, "Reduce social media use to 30 minutes per day," or "No screen time 1 hour before bed."
- **Identify Strategies and Tools:** Decide which strategies and tools will help you achieve your goals. This might include using app blockers during certain times of the day or deleting particularly distracting apps from your phone.
- **Plan for Challenges:** Anticipate obstacles and plan how you'll address them. If you know you tend to browse your phone out of boredom, plan alternative activities to fill your time.
- **Track Your Progress:** Keep a journal or use an app to track your progress toward your goals. Celebrate your successes and reassess your strategies if you're struggling to meet your objectives.

Apps to Support Your Goals

- **Moment or QualityTime:** These apps provide detailed insights into your phone usage and can help you track your progress over time.
- **Headspace or Calm:** If one of your goals is to spend more time in mindfulness or meditation, these apps offer guided sessions that can help you replace screen time with more restorative activities.

Recognising your unhealthy digital habits and setting personalised goals for your digital detox are critical steps in creating a healthier relationship with technology. By identifying and addressing the digital behaviours that don't serve you, you can begin to make more intentional choices about how you use your time and attention. As you move forward, remember that digital detox is not about perfection but about making progress towards a more balanced and fulfilling digital life. 